Lemon Butter Parmesan Asparagus

Oven-roasted asparagus finished under the broiler with lemon, butter, and parmesan.

SERVES **8, AS A SIDE** · ACTIVE **10 MIN** · TOTAL **25 MIN**

INGREDIENTS

2 lb	asparagus, trimmed
1	lemon, half juiced and half sliced into rings
4 tbsp	unsalted butter, cut into pats
1 tbsp	olive oil
1 tsp	sea salt, or to taste
1/2 tsp	black pepper, freshly ground, or to taste
1/2 cup	shredded parmesan cheese, or to taste

METHOD

1. Arrange the trimmed asparagus in a single layer on a rimmed baking sheet. Drizzle with the olive oil, season with the salt and pepper, and roll to coat evenly.
2. Squeeze the juice of half the lemon over the asparagus. Lay the lemon rings across the top third of the spears, then scatter the butter pats over the center.
3. Roast at **400F (200C)** for **8 to 10 minutes**, until just fork-tender — thin spears finish nearer **8 minutes**, thick spears nearer **12 minutes**. Pull the pan and switch the oven to broil.
4. Scatter the parmesan over the center of the asparagus and broil **2 to 3 minutes**, until melted and golden.

NOTES

- To trim: hold each spear at the base, bend until it snaps naturally (usually **1 to 2 inches** from the base); for thick stalks, peel the fibrous skin off the bottom half instead.
- Bake time scales with thickness: thin spears about **8 minutes**, medium about **10 minutes**, thick about **12 minutes**, all followed by the same broil.
- Make-ahead: bake fully, cover, and refrigerate; reheat gently in the oven before serving (per the author, replying to readers).
- Several readers report good results in an air fryer, though this isn't a technique the author has tested herself — start checking a few minutes early.
- Good without the parmesan if you want it dairy-light; a scatter of lemon zest in its place is a reader favorite.

PER SERVING

109 cal · 6 g carbs · 4 g protein · 9 g fat

OLIVE OIL, TOMATO & HERB

VEGETABLE MAIN · ROAST, THEN BROIL, 400F

UNITED STATES AND CANADA

Adapted from Natasha's Kitchen, natashaskitchen.com. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.